Computerized designing systems use software specifically designed for the development of industry specific objects, input and output of graphics, scanners and other remote devices. Computer systems allow making two-dimensional and three-dimensional product illustrations and visualizations. It is possible to create computer-aided garment patterns, gradations, and a virtual pattern. Such computer-aided operations significantly save time and costs necessary to design a product. The cost of a product can be calculated with the help of the product management systems of the company stored in a database.

Recently, a variety of CAD systems have been widely used in the field of fashion. The software system like Lectra gives a comparative concentration on the integration of CAD software. The system has adopted new strategies to expand its technology and provide a system of simulation for the entire textile industry from yarn and textile design; manufacture of virtual goods and to the ready-to-wear since 1998. It represents the direction of development of a new generation of textile and clothing in computer aided design.

Assyst Bullmer system can simulate three-dimensional effect which can give the design structure and fabric. It also has more than 400 different kinds of databases for optional format-making, picturizing and modifying. It can make a format automatically and according to the actual size, it can change the size freely. The system also has intelligent database, which can make styles quick and efficient. Spanish Investronica system has made more effective efforts in the application of artificial intelligence and other technologies.

15.8 SUMMARY

Computers play a major role in the Apparel Industry. Right from designing to manufacture of garments, specialised CAD and CAM systems are utilised. Newer designs can be created and stored for future use also. Mass production of textile and apparel goods require CAD and CAM systems to reduce the lead time for delivery of goods. In the era of globalisation, there is a great competition for the apparel manufactures to deliver goods in international standards. Use of advanced CAD and CAM systems is the smartest way and the industries could cater to the huge demand of textiles and apparel goods.

POINTS TO REMEMBER

- In the field of garment industry, computers help to design, analyse and manufacture the product within a short span of time.
- CAD software has begun to make inroads into the world of fashion and textile industry, enable mass customization, develop more designs, and facilitate to make frequent changes in style and production.
- The apparel industry has started using size designation systems, garment style, design, and colour combination to produce and sell ready-to-wear clothing.

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